

Preface

This seventh edition of *Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation* helps to officially acknowledge that physical medicine and rehabilitation (PM&R) has moved boldly into the future of health care, embracing all of the potential that technologic and intellectual advances can offer, while building off of the 75-year formal foundation of the specialty and the millennia of rehabilitative practice across time. Regenerative medicine, virtual care, stem cells, genetic engineering, AI-driven diagnostics, brain-computer interface, osseointegration, robotics, wearable diagnostics, and implantable stimulators are no longer simply within the realm of researchers and inventors but are now an integral component of PM&R clinicians' practices. At the same time that these technologic advances are enriching care, PM&R is also increasingly seeing a greater acceptance—even resurgence—of person-centric, integrative medicine with its whole-health approach to care that was an overarching tenet of PM&R before it became popular, simply because it has always produced the greatest level of patient satisfaction, clinician-patient engagement, and clinical impact and best outcomes.

In parallel to this blend of technology and holistic care, there has been a highly welcomed renewed focus on physical activity, nutrition, restorative sleep, emotional health, mind-body interactions, and other vital elements of health and wellness across the lifespan that are leading to further innovation and advances in the long-term care of disability. Importantly, PM&R is also increasingly recognizing the value of a personalized approach to care that emphasizes the individualization needed to optimize PM&R practice for unique populations of individuals at risk for or with disability, including those with specific social determinants of health, service members, veterans, first responders, women, children, elders, athletes, and high-risk workers. All of these improvements on PM&R have been in response to individuals living longer, demanding more from their bodies and minds, seeking more from health care providers, actively engaging in all aspects of their health and wellness, and having higher expectations for their recovery and functioning than ever before. While prior PM&R clinical successes targeted lifesaving or life-lengthening discoveries, approaches, and interventions, today's individuals with disabilities and their caregivers are not only expecting to

survive their acute incident or injury but also to thrive and return to an even higher level of living, working, and playing. The physiatrist is being asked to balance the holistic approach with cutting-edge technology, to combine modern science with old-world beliefs and practices, and to heal the mind, body, and soul. This textbook meets these challenges by bringing together an internationally renowned team of authors and associate editors from the full range of PM&R practices and systems who have created up-to-date, informative, and practical chapters covering the breadth of the field. The best of academic medicine, private practice, veterans and military health, all aspects of rehabilitative services, integrative clinicians, and a wide range of specialty areas have been brought together to provide the most up-to-date and useful resource for the field.

This updated and expanded seventh edition of *Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation* remains the foundational textbook of PM&R that is an invaluable, practical resource for rehabilitation clinicians and trainees and serves as a key reference across rehabilitation disciplines by providing traditional core written materials supplemented by state-of-the-art virtual teaching and training materials. As with the field of PM&R, this textbook is being continually reinvented and improved to meet the needs of trainees and clinicians as they seek to enhance the recoveries, outcomes, and long-term well-being of individuals with disability.

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